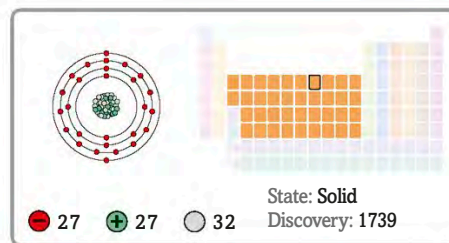


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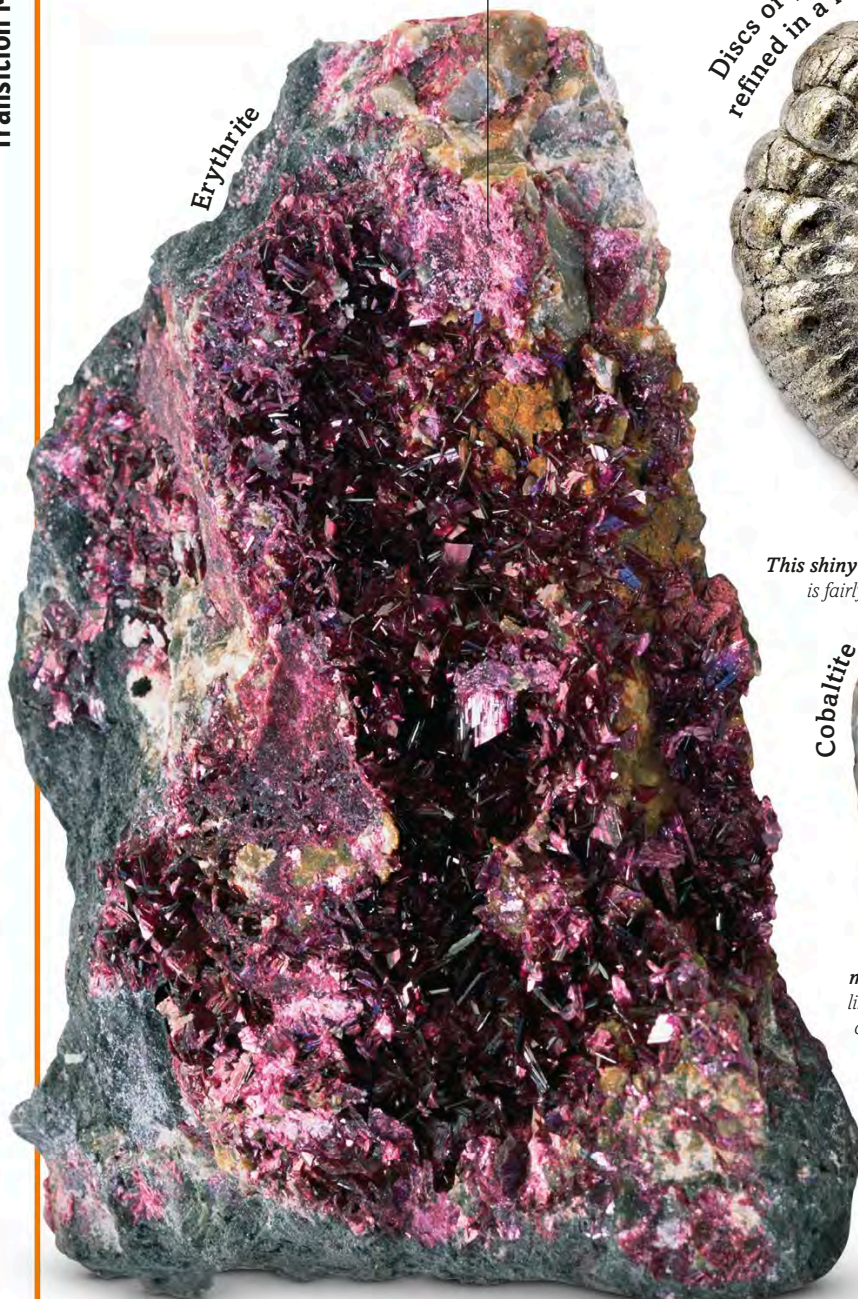
Cobalt



Forms

The distinctive purplish colour gives it the nickname "red cobalt".

Discs of pure cobalt refined in a laboratory



Erythrite



This shiny metal is fairly hard.

Cobaltite



These cubic crystals contain a sulfur compound of cobalt.

This silvery mineral smells like garlic when crushed due to the presence of arsenic.



Skutterudite

Medieval German miners often mistook ores of cobalt for precious metals. When they tried to purify these, the arsenic gas released made them sick. This unwanted side-effect led to the name *kobold*, which is German for "goblin", a mischievous spirit.

Pure cobalt is hard and shiny, and is added to steel and other alloys to make them stronger. Alloys containing cobalt are used in the blades of **jet engines** and in **artificial joints**, such as hip and knee joints. Cobalt is one of the few elements